



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Rocky Bayou Christian School: Niceville
School Website: <http://rbcs.org>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Rocky Bayou Christian School (Niceville, FL 32578) presents a clearly Christian, formation-focused educational ethos with strong emphasis on parental partnership and a shared mission to cultivate a biblical worldview, Christian character, and spiritual formation in students. The public materials consistently foreground faith, worship, and the integration of theology with daily learning. While the school demonstrates classical-inflected commitments (formation, virtue, truth as a transcendent good, reverence for the sacred, and a living-teacher model), its explicit articulation of canonical classical elements such as a grammar-logic-rhetoric Trivium, Great Books, or a heavy emphasis on Socratic pedagogy is less overt in the available materials. On balance, RBCS aligns with a Classical orientation in meaningful ways (true formation, virtue, theology, liturgical community, strong faculty/community emphasis) but does not consistently foreground the full canonical classical curriculum and pedagogy in public-facing materials. Thus, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with a notable potential to strengthen explicit classical-curriculum and classical-pedagogy signals to achieve a fuller Classical profile.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are front-and-center: explicit biblical worldview, theology, catechetical content, and liturgical community (chapel, worship) are repeatedly referenced. This strongly supports Element 1 as CLASSICAL. Evidence: Mission & Vision statements and chapel/worship references.

- School purpose aligns with formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth as real and knowable through a biblical lens, supported by mission statements and values statements. Element 2 is CLASSICAL. - Curriculum signals center on Christian worldview across courses, with explicit "Biblical Worldview" in pedagogy; however, explicit canonical-classical curriculum signals (Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric) are not overtly presented in public content. Element 3 leans toward NOT CLASSICAL rather than fully Classical, with some alignment toward Somewhat Classical given the formation emphasis. - Pedagogy appears to mix contemplative, memory-based elements (singing, memory work in lower grades) with more advanced, discussion-oriented practices in upper levels, but without explicit, uniform Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across grades. Element 4 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Faculty is described as virtuous, mentor-like, and living curriculum—strong Classical signals in Element 5. - Parents & community are positioned as co-educators and partners with active family formation opportunities, strongly supporting Element 6.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize biblical worldview, Christian truth, and theological commitments. Examples include mission statements and philosophy materials highlighting biblical truth and the Lordship of Jesus Christ.
 - Liturgical/community practices are evident through chapel/worship components (Praise Band and weekly chapel).
 - The Niceville campus public content notes a consistent Christian curriculum across campuses.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

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- Positive indicators observed: “biblical worldview”, “Christian character”, “theology”, “chapel”, “worship”, “God’s calling”, “biblical truth” (multiple explicit hits in RBCS materials). Estimated positive keyword hits: 6; Negative hits: 0.
 - Why this rating
 - The school’s core aims and practices are explicitly anchored in Christian theology, liturgy, and a transcendent moral order, aligning closely with the Positive Keyword set for Religious and Meta-physical Foundations. This is a robust CLASSICAL signal.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission & Vision repeatedly center formation in virtue and wisdom through a biblical framework (glorifying God, biblical worldview, Christian character, formation of the person).
 - Emphasis on formation and human flourishing through a theology-infused liberal education approach.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators: terms like “formation” (in the formation sense), “virtue/character”, “biblical worldview”, “great conversation/teleology” (conceptual alignment in the provided lexicon), and “truth” as an objective good. Estimated positive keyword hits: 5; Negative hits: 0.
- Why this rating
 - RBCS treats education as formation in virtue and wisdom within a Christian teleology, rather than solely job preparation, matching the Classical emphasis on formation and transcendent aims.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL (leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe a Christian curriculum used across campuses and a slate of traditional subjects (Literacy, World Geography, History, Science, Math, languages, Fine Arts, etc.). Some explicit emphasis on biblical worldview in coursework (e.g., “All Rocky classes are taught from a Biblical Worldview”).
 - History and geography are taught, but there is no explicit documentation of Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric triad, Latin/Greek; Great Books/Great Conversation signals are not evident in the public content.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators present: “History” across curriculum, “World Geography”, “biblical worldview” (which can align with a Christian approach to the humanities). Estimated positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 1 (absence of core canonical-classical signals like Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric explicitly called out). Total matched keywords: 3; Positive: 2; Negative: 1.
- Why this rating
 - Although RBCS employs a robust Christian curriculum with historical and humanities components, the explicit classical-curriculum markers (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) are not clearly articulated in public RBCS materials. This yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3, with some partial alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) if a broader interpretation of curriculum as classical formation is allowed. Given the explicit rubric, the clearer read is NOT CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Lower grades show memory- and recitation-like elements (singing, memory work) and a contemplative/restful dimension in some descriptions. Upper grades describe seminars and rhetoric training within a classical frame, but explicit Socratic practice is not consistently documented across the site. Public materials mention opportunities for worship, memory-based activities, and

classical-feeling pedagogy in parts of the program, but not a uniform Socratic-method approach across grades.

- The school emphasizes a living, relational faculty, and a small-class environment that can support Socratic-like discussions when appropriate, though not uniformly asserted as a core method.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators: “Socratic dialogue” and “great conversation” (conceptual alignment) appear as classical keywords in the lexicon; in RBCS materials, there are hints of discussion-based learning in upper grades and a rhetoric/involvement emphasis (e.g., Praise Band and chapel-based experiences). Estimated positive hits: 3; Negative hits: 1 (explicit project-based/experiential-only pedagogy is not emphasized; the site does not prominently push PBL as the central approach). Total matched keywords: 4; Positive: 3; Negative: 1.
- Why this rating
 - RBCS demonstrates a blend: memory-based and contemplative elements in some grades and discussion/rhetoric opportunities in others, with explicit Socratic pedagogy not uniformly highlighted. This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The faculty are portrayed as role models and living curriculum; a “faculty as the living curriculum” notion is described, with a family-like culture and close relationships. The school emphasizes “called, gifted, and Godly faculty” who deeply commit to students and Christian education.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators: phrases like “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty as core” are present in public statements. Estimated positive hits: 4; Negative hits: 0.
- Why this rating
 - The explicit framing of faculty as the core of the school’s ethos and as exemplars of virtue and skill aligns strongly with Classical expectations for the faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school frames parents as partners and co-teachers, with explicit calls for parent formation, book studies, and community gatherings; campus visits are welcomed, and parental involvement is encouraged.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators: “Partnership with families,” “co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “reading groups,” “seminars/book clubs,” “open campus,” “parental involvement.” Estimated positive hits: 5; Negative hits: 0.
- Why this rating
 - RBCS places parents in an essential, active partnership role in formation and education, consistent with Classical expectations for parental engagement and community partnership.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

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- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Make explicit the canonical classical curriculum signals in public materials, including:
 - A visible, school-wide emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the Trivium) across grade levels, with documented syllabi and assessment aligned to the Trivium stages.
 - Public articulation of Great Books and Great Conversation commitments, including sample reading lists and integrated discussions across the humanities, as well as Latin/Greek or classical language options where relevant.
 - Clear demonstration of a history-intensive curriculum that foregrounds Western civilization, classical canon, and primary sources.
 - For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Expand explicit classical pedagogical practices by:
 - Publishing a formal description of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars as a core upper-school method, with teacher training and assessment rubrics.
 - Increasing explicit emphasis on disciplined memory work, recitation, and oratory across more grades, with performance-based assessments and public speaking opportunities.
 - Documenting how *scholé* (restful, contemplative learning) is practiced on a formal schedule and how it complements rigorous inquiry.
 - For Element 2 (School Purpose): While formation is strong, a more explicit articulation of the classical telos and how truth, goodness, and beauty guide daily decision-making and curriculum could strengthen overall alignment.
 - For Element 1 and Element 5–6: Maintain and deepen the existing strengths in liturgical/community life, theology, and parental partnership, ensuring continued alignment with classical aims and outcomes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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